Literature

Paper 3

1. Quote lines (cannot be too long). "This is evident in A1S1, where Caesar says".
2. State the literary techniques / meaning behind keywords / phrases. "The phrase '...' uses a metaphor, which shows that".

Literary Techniques

1. Ethos, pathos, logos.
2. Metaphor, simile, personification, alliteration, onomatopoeia, hyperbole.
3. Irony, paradox, oxymoron, allusion.
4. Repetition, pun, rhetorical question, foreshadowing, allegory, anachronism.

Act 1

A1S1 Analysis.pdf, A1S1 Checkpoint.pdf

Paying close attention to the language in this extract, discuss how the tribunes utilise various techniques to get the plebeians to disperse.

Marullus employs hyperbole to remind the plebeians of their former loyalty to Pompey, thereby undermining their support for Caesar. This is evident in the line, “Many a time and oft / Have you climbed up to walls and battlements, / To towers and windows, yea, to chimney-tops.” The exaggeration in this list, along with the repetition of similar ideas, emphasises how eagerly the plebeians once admired Pompey. The image of people climbing to “chimney-tops” highlights their intense admiration, contrasting with their current celebration of Caesar. Marullus reinforces this by stating, “Have you not made an universal shout, / That Tiber trembled underneath her banks.” The word “universal” suggests unanimous loyalty, while the personification of Tiber “trembling” conveys the overwhelming power of their cheers. This emotional manipulation serves to shame the plebeians for their fickle loyalty, effectively convincing them to disperse. Through this exaggeration, Marullus successfully undermines their enthusiasm for Caesar and restores order.

The tribunes use command words to assert their authority and compel the plebeians to disperse. This is evident in the line, “Be gone!” The shortness of this line emphasises the sharpness of the command, conveying a tone of authority and urgency. The abruptness leaves no room for argument, forcing the plebeians to comply. Flavius adopts a slightly different approach, commanding, “Go, go, good countrymen, and for this fault / Assemble all the poor men of your sort; / Draw them to Tiber banks.” Here, the repetitive commands “Go, go” create a sense of urgency, while the use of “good countrymen” makes his order seem more reconciliatory, appealing to their sense of duty as Romans. Additionally, the word “countrymen” reminds the plebeians of their civic responsibilities, subtly shaming them for betraying the Republic by celebrating Caesar. Through this assertive language, the tribunes effectively reestablish control and disperse the crowd.

A1S2 Analysis.pdf, A1S2 Checkpoint.pdf

Quote	Example
"I know that virtue to be in you, Brutus... Well, honour is the subject of my story" L90-92	**Purpose:** Establishes Cassius' credibility by acknowledging Brutus' virtue and aligning his argument with Brutus' values of honour and integrity. By framing the discussion as one about honour, Cassius presents himself as morally upright and principled. **Effect on Brutus:** Builds trust and reinforces Brutus' self-image as

Quote	Example
	honourable, making him more open to Cassius' arguments and more susceptible to seeing the conspiracy as a noble cause.
"I was born free as Caesar; so were you: We both have fed as well, and we can both Endure the winter's cold as well as he" L97-99	**Purpose:** Establishes equality between Cassius, Brutus, and Caesar, emphasising that they share the same noble birth and capabilities. This undermines Caesar's perceived superiority. **Effect on Brutus:** Encourages Brutus to see himself as Caesar's equal, prompting him to question why Caesar should be exalted above them.
"I did hear him groan... As a sick girl." L124-128	**Purpose:** Uses firsthand observation of Caesar's weaknesses to question his strength and divinity, positioning Cassius as a credible witness to Caesar's mortality and fallibility. **Effect on Brutus:** Diminishes Caesar's godlike image in Brutus' eyes, making him seem more human and vulnerable.
"And this man is now become a god, and Cassius is a wretched creature... If Caesar carelessly but nod on him." L115-118	**Purpose:** Evokes a sense of injustice and resentment by contrasting Caesar's rise to power with Cassius' subservience. This emotional appeal highlights the indignity of being subordinate to someone they once considered an equal. **Effect on Brutus:** Stirs feelings of humiliation and resentment in Brutus, prompting him to reflect on his own status under Caesar's rule.
"Why, man, he doth bestride the narrow world Like a Colossus, and we petty men Walk under his huge legs" L135-137	**Purpose:** Uses vivid imagery to evoke feelings of insignificance and oppression under Caesar's dominance. The comparison to the Colossus magnifies Caesar's power and belittles others' status. **Effect on Brutus:** Challenges Brutus' pride and sense of self-worth, motivating him to consider reclaiming his honour and status.
"Rome, thou hast lost the breed of noble bloods!... That her wide walls encompass'd but one man?" L151-153	**Purpose:** Appeals to Brutus' patriotism and nostalgia for Rome's former glory, suggesting that Caesar's rise represents the decline of Roman nobility and virtue. **Effect on Brutus:** Inspires a sense of duty to restore Rome's honor, encouraging Brutus to act in the name of patriotism and legacy.
"There was a Brutus once that would have brook'd The eternal devil to keep his state in Rome As easily as a king." L159-161	**Purpose:** Evokes ancestral pride, referencing Brutus' lineage to inspire him to live up to his family's legacy. **Effect on Brutus:** Appeals to Brutus' sense of honour and familial duty, motivating him to act courageously.
"Men at some time are masters of their fates: The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, But in ourselves, that we are underlings." L139-141	**Purpose:** Emphasises free will and personal responsibility, arguing that their submission is not predestined but a result of their own inaction. **Effect on Brutus:** Empowers Brutus to take control of his fate, challenging him to rise above his subordinate position.
"Brutus and Caesar: what should be in that 'Caesar'? Why should that name be sounded more than yours? Write them together, yours is as fair a name; Sound them, it doth become the mouth as well; Weigh them, it is as heavy" L142-146	**Purpose:** Logical comparison of their names, emphasising equality in worth and stature. This reasoning questions the validity of Caesar's elevated status. **Effect on Brutus:**

Quote	Example
	Persuades Brutus to see himself as Caesar's equal, challenging him to consider his own leadership potential.

A1S3 Analysis.pdf, A1S3 Checkpoint.pdf

1. Cassius makes Casca fear Caesar's power.
   This can be seen from: "I know where I will wear this dagger then: Cassius from bondage will deliver Cassius." (line 89).
   This can be seen from the use of similes: "Poor man, I know he would not be a wolf/ But that he sees the Romans are but sheep; / He were no lion, were not Romans hinds. (lines 104 – 106)
   This can also be seen from the use of vivid imagery: "What trash is Rome, / What rubbish, and what offal when it serves." (lines 108 – 109)
   This worked on Casca because Cassius suggests that Caesar's rule is like enslavement and that he would rather die than live under tyranny, making Casca feel that action is necessary. Cassius is also emphasising the degraded and shameful present state of affairs in Rome.
2. Cassius uses flattery to make Casca feel important and valued.
   This can be seen from: "Come, Casca, you and I will yet, ere day / See Brutus at his house." (lines 153 – 154)
   This technique worked because by including Casca in his plans, it makes Casca feel like an essential part of the conspiracy rather than just a follower.
3. Cassius uses peer pressure to make Casca feel like he's part of a larger movement
   This can be seen from: "There's a bargain made. / Now know you, Casca, I have mov'd already / Some certain of the noblest-minded Romans. / To undergo with me an enterprise / Of honourable dangerous consequence." (lines 121 – 124)
   This worked because Cassius assures Casca that many senators, including Brutus, are already on board, making it harder for Casca to say no.
4. Cassius belittles Casca's courage and pretends he has spoken too openly.
   This can be seen from: "So every bondman in his own hand bears / The power to cancel his captivity." (lines 101 – 102).
   This can also be seen from: "But, O grief, / Where hast thou led me? I perhaps speak this / Before a willing bondman" (lines 111 – 113)
   This worked because Cassius is suggesting that anyone who does nothing against Caesar is weak, making Casca feel that taking action is the only honourable option. He is also being deliberately provocative by suggesting that Casca may be a "willing bondman".

Act 2

A2S1 Checkpoint.pdf

1. Where does Brutus' logic become flawed or shaky?
   Brutus admits that Caesar has not done anything wrong yet, but argues that he might become dangerous if crowned. The logic becomes flawed when he decides that Caesar must be killed not for what he has done, but for what he might do. This is a slippery moral argument because it punishes potential rather than action.
2. Is this decision based more on fear or honour?
   Though Brutus frames his decision as being for the "general good" and out of honour, his logic is heavily driven by fear — specifically, fear of what Caesar might become. He's anxious about the corrupting nature of power, even though he has no proof Caesar will misuse it. So while he speaks of honour, the motivation is largely fear disguised as principle.

Brutus's state of mind

1. **Reference to sleeplessness or physical unrest**
   Quote (Line): Since Cassius first did whet me against Caesar / I have not slept (lines 61 to 62)

Explanation: Reminder of Brutus' inner turmoil. The conspiracy has disturbed his peace of mind, and his body is reacting to the moral weight of the decision.

2. **Metaphor for internal conflict**
   Quote (Line): The genius and the mortal instruments / Are then in council, and the state of a man, / Like to a little kingdom, suffers then / The nature of an insurrection (lines 66 to 69)
   Explanation: Brutus uses a metaphor to describe the conflict inside himself. He says his "genius" (his conscience or reason) and his "mortal instruments" (his body and emotions) are having a debate. This shows he feels torn between what he thinks is right and what he feels. He compares himself to a little kingdom that is going through an insurrection, or civil war. This shows that his mind is in chaos. He is struggling to decide what to do and feels disturbed by the whole situation. The metaphor shows that Brutus is deeply conflicted and that his decision to kill Caesar is not easy or clear for him.
3. **An example of personification**
   Quote (Line): O'conspiracy, / Sham'st thou to show thy dang'rous brow at night (lines 77 to 78)
   Explanation: Brutus personifies the conspiracy, speaking to it as if it were a living being. Conspiracy is likened to an evil and dangerous monster which is so grotesque that not even darkness can conceal its ugly presence. This shows how Brutus sees the plot as both powerful and morally repulsive.
4. **An example of irony**
   Quote (Line): Hide it in smiles and affability, / For if thou path, thy native semblance on, / Not Erebus itself were dim enough / To hide thee from prevention.
   Explanation: The conspirators must pretend to be friendly while secretly plotting Caesar's death — this is dramatic irony, since the audience knows their intentions. Brutus recognises that success depends on deception, which adds to the tension and his guilt. He is honest about being dishonest.

Argument for Killing Anthony	Reference
Killing Antony removes another threat.	Let Antony and Caesar fall together (line 161) → Cassius suggests that Antony is part of the same danger as Caesar and should be eliminated at the same time.
Antony is closely tied to Caesar.	And for Mark Antony, think not of him; / For he can do no more than Caesar's arm / When Caesar's head is off. (lines 181–184 said by Brutus, but used here by Cassius to justify his disagreement) → Antony is seen as an extension of Caesar's power, like a limb to a body. This makes him dangerous if left alive.
Antony could turn the public against them.	Yet I fear him; / For in the ingrafted love he bears to Caesar (line 184) → Cassius fears that Antony's love for Caesar will lead him to seek revenge and rally public support against the conspirators.
It is safer to eliminate all powerful allies at once.	Let us be sacrificers, but not butchers, Caius. (line 166) → Although this is Brutus rejecting the idea, it confirms that Cassius' proposal was to kill all at once to eliminate threats completely.

Arguments against killing Anthony	Reference
Killing Antony would make them seem too violent.	Let us be sacrificers, but not butchers, Caius. (line 166) → Brutus draws a line between necessary political action and outright bloodshed. Killing Antony would make the plot seem cruel.
They want to be seen as noble, not bloodthirsty.	This shall make / Our purpose necessary and not envious. (lines 177–178) → Brutus wants their actions to look like they were done for the good of Rome and not out of jealousy, spite, or personal ambition.
Antony won't be dangerous without Caesar.	For he can do no more than Caesar's arm / When Caesar's head is off. (Lines 182–183) → Brutus sees Antony as powerless without Caesar. He believes removing Caesar will leave Antony with no influence or leadership.
The act should look like a sacrifice, not a massacre.	Let us be sacrificers, but not butchers, Caius. (line 166) → Repeated here because it strongly conveys Brutus' desire to maintain the image of a righteous, almost religious act and not a bloodbath.

A2S2 Checkpoint.pdf, Sympathy.pdf, Character Map.pdf

We sympathise with characters in literature for a variety of psychological, emotional, and narrative reasons.

1. Shared Human Experience
   When a character goes through something universally relatable (loss, love, fear, insecurity), readers often connect emotionally.
2. Vulnerability or Suffering
   Characters who are in pain, marginalised, or treated unjustly often evoke sympathy.
3. Moral Integrity or Good Intentions
   Even flawed characters can earn our sympathy if their intentions are good or they try to do the right thing.
4. Helplessness or Powerlessness
   Characters who are powerless against larger forces (e.g. poverty, fate, war, systems) often draw empathy.
5. Character Growth or Redemption
   Watching a character learn, grow, or redeem themselves can earn our sympathy and respect.
6. Isolation or Alienation
   Characters who are misunderstood or isolated can evoke pity and understanding.
7. Flawed but Human
   Characters with flaws (impatience, fear, pride) feel real and human, which often increases our empathy.
8. Unjust Circumstances
   When characters suffer due to fate, society, or other uncontrollable forces, readers often side with them.

[A2S3 & A2S4 Checkpoint.pdf]

If only Caesar had listened to

1. Caesar should have listened to the Soothsayer because he gave a direct warning about the danger ahead.
   This character warned Caesar by saying, “Beware the Ides of March.”
   However, Caesar’s tragic flaw of overconfidence made him ignore this advice because he believed he was untouchable and mocked the warning, calling the Soothsayer a “dreamer.”
   If he had listened, he might have stayed home or investigated further, possibly avoiding the assassination.
   Compared to the others, this advice was more important because it was a clear and early warning that predicted the exact day of danger.
2. Caesar should have listened to Calpurnia because she was genuinely concerned for his safety and had disturbing dreams that reflected the truth.
   This character warned Caesar by saying that her dreams were omens and begged him not to go to the Capitol.
   However, Caesar’s tragic flaw of pride and a sense of invincibility made him ignore this advice because he didn’t want to look weak by giving in to a woman’s fears.
   If he had listened, he would have stayed at home and avoided the conspirators entirely.
   Compared to the others, this advice was more important because it came from someone who cared deeply for him and was based on powerful symbolism and emotional appeal.
3. Caesar should have listened more carefully to Decius to uncover the manipulation behind his words.
   This character persuaded Caesar by twisting Calpurnia’s dream into a flattering prophecy and claiming the Senate might change their minds about offering him the crown.
   However, Caesar’s tragic flaw of overconfidence and a need for control made him believe what he wanted to hear instead of questioning Decius’s intentions.
   If he had listened more carefully, he might have sensed the deception and chosen to stay home.
   Compared to the others, this persuasion was most dangerous because it played directly into Caesar’s ego and led him to walk willingly into his death.
4. Caesar should have listened to Artemidorus because he had specific knowledge of the conspiracy and named the conspirators directly.
   This character warned Caesar by writing a letter listing the names of those who were plotting against him, urging him to read it “swiftly.”
   However, Caesar’s tragic flaw of superiority complex made him ignore this advice because he believed matters of personal concern could wait, and he wanted to appear focused on public business.
   If he had listened, he would have been alerted to the betrayal and could have defended himself or escaped.

Compared to the others, this advice was more important because it was factual, immediate, and actionable. It was not symbolic or vague.

Act 3

A3S1 Analysis.pdf, A3S1 Checkpoint.pdf, A3S2 & S3 Checkpoint.pdf, Funeral Speech.pdf, Paper 3.pdf